

Real or Pretend?



BIG IDEA Pictures and voices can be pretend, even if they look and sound real. When I'm not sure, I Pause and Check with a grown-up.

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

1 HOOK 2 MIN *60-second script* Hold up the “flying pig” card. “A flying pig! Is that real? (Children: “No!”) Somebody drew it, or a computer made it. It is a **pretend picture**, and pretend pictures can be fun. Here is something amazing and a little tricky: **computers can make pretend pictures and pretend voices that look and sound real**. A computer can make a voice that sounds like a grown-up but isn't. It is like a very good costume. Most of the time it is just for fun. Sometimes it might try to **fool** us. So we **Pause**, and we **Check** with a grown-up we trust.”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN *Real or Pretend Parade*

- 1 (1 min) Body vote:** Real = hands on heart; Pretend = hands wiggle like a magic spell.
- 2 (3 min) Card parade.** Children vote on each card. Ask “why” for the flying pig and the two hard cards: “This looks real, but a computer made it. That’s why we Check.” Say once: “It’s okay not to know.”
- 3 (2 min) Mystery voice.** From behind a bag, a silly robot voice: “Hello, friends! I am Robo Pal. Tell me your name and where you live!” Children: Pause Palm, “Pause! Check with a grown-up!” Then reveal. Never imitate a real person.
- 4 (1 min) Three Check ideas:** ask a grown-up; look for clues; use the family code word.
- 5 (1 min) Wrap up:** pretend is fun when we know it’s pretend.

DIFFERENTIATE Use the obviously pretend cards plus 3 real ones. If a child finds pretend voices scary, keep the voice silly and let them choose it.

FAMILY CARD Choose a **family code word** only your family knows. Tell your child: “If a voice or message asks you to do something strange, even if it sounds like me, check with the code word.” Never write it on the reply slip.

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: 10 Real-or-Pretend picture cards (5 real, 5 pretend, two of them hard), a paper bag or book for the “mystery voice,” floor spots “Real” and “Pretend.”

- ☐ Place the Real and Pretend floor spots.
- ☐ Shuffle the 10 cards, flying pig on top.
- ☐ Pick a silly robot voice (never a real person’s voice).

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** “Can a computer make a voice?” (Yes! It can sound very real.)
- 2** “Why do we need a family code word?” (So we know it’s really our family.)
- 3** “Is it okay if we can’t tell?” (Yes! Even grown-ups check.)

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “**Pictures and voices can be pretend. When I’m not sure, I Pause and Check with a grown-up.**”

Hand signal: **Pause** when it seems strange (palm). **Check** with a grown-up or the code word (eyes). **Tell** what I saw and heard.

EXIT TICKET Draw a **question mark** on the picture you would **Check**. Any answer is fine if the child pauses on at least one.

FUN BOOST Real or Pretend Freeze (30 seconds). Call out silly statements (“A pig flies!”), body vote, freeze in a pose that shows it.

LEVEL-UP Code Word Practice (pretend!). Say “What’s our code word?” to a stuffed animal, never a real code word at school.

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** “Thank you for telling me.”
- “I believe you. It is not your fault.”
- “I will get help from someone whose job is to keep kids safe.”
- **Do not say:** “I promise I won’t tell anyone.”
- “Why didn’t you tell me sooner?” or “Are you sure?”
- Any leading question (“Did he touch you?”).

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: tell your counselor or designated person right away. Follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law.